Chip Companion: Poker Bankroll Tracking

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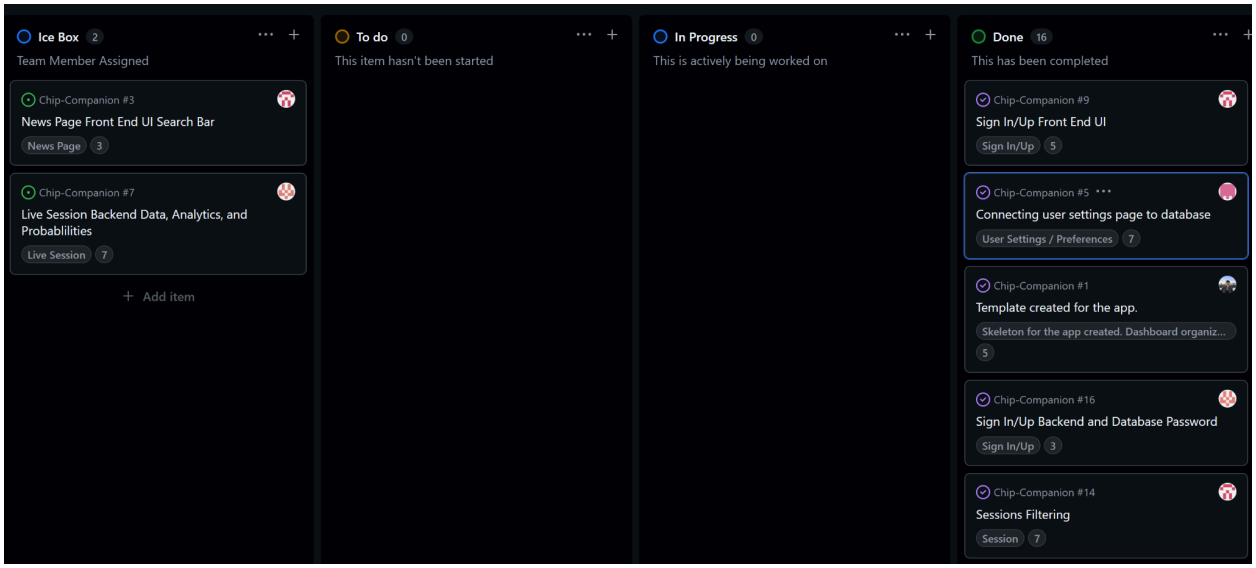
Project Description:

Chip Companion is the hub for all poker players who are serious about statistics, tracking profit (or loss), and news throughout the professional world of poker. Users are able to create an account or just sign in using google to gain access to all of the exciting features that Chip Companion has to offer. Users can log old or live sessions to help track stakes, buy-in, cash out, rebuys, hours played, net profit or loss, net profit per hour, location, and date. Users can then filter this data to view statistics data and visualize trends and analytics. Users can also start a live session to keep track of rebuys and profit in real time! Chip Companion also offers a look into the world of professional poker through its interactive news page. Users can also customize their experience through the intuitive settings page.

Project Tracker

We used GitHub Projects to manage task tracking throughout the project. The link to access the project tracker is below.

https://github.com/users/Medoriku/projects/2



Since development has been finished of the app, all of our major tasks have been marked as done. The only tasks remaining are two tasks that were identified as additional work and not a part of the core functionality and thus are in Ice Box.

Video

Here is a link to the demo video: **Chip_Companion_Video.MOV**

VCS

We used GitHub as our version control. The link to the repository is below.
https://github.com/Medoriku/Chip-Companion

Contributions

Aiden English - Worked on the sessions API. Created routes to insert user sessions into the database. Also created routes to edit existing sessions databases. Modified the sessions frontend to include an edit button for each user session, and added frontend javascript to populate the sessions modal to allow users to edit existing sessions. Hosted the API and database on the frontend.

Trace Rindal - Worked on the Live Sessions page and the User Settings page. Created the UI and logic to keep track of and display relevant information while the user is in a live session. Live sessions piggy-backed off the work for the regular Sessions page to follow the same submission format to the database. Minor additions to the header for user login logic for clarity of what is accessible during different user states. Miscellaneous tasks handled during debugging as presentation approached (minor sql restructuring to match session info).

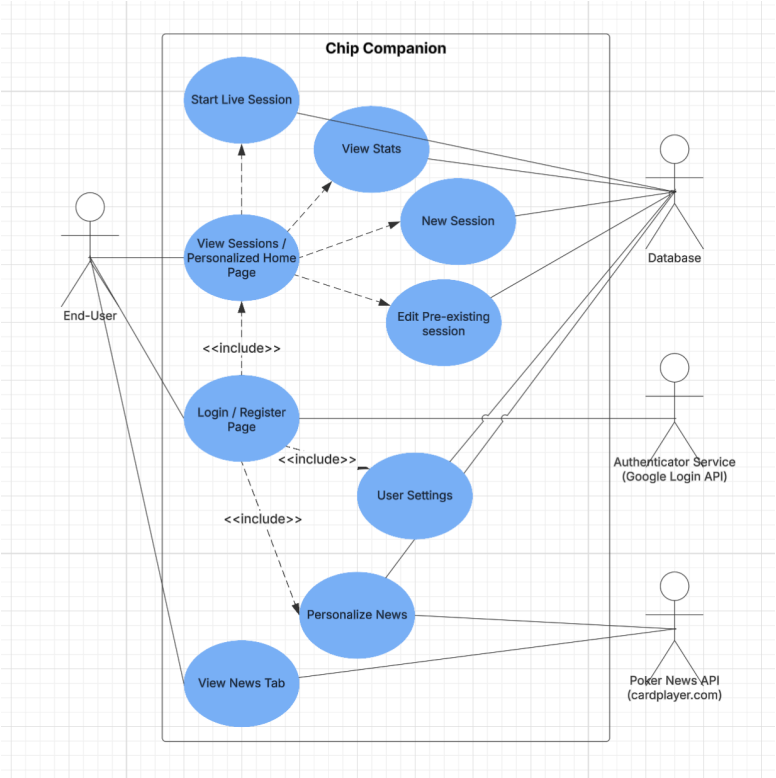
Hasan Kobeissy - I was responsible for developing the backend API for the news page. I implemented an Express route that fetches poker news from an external RSS feed and used the rss-parser library to convert the XML data into JSON format for the frontend. I structured the API to return key fields such as title, URL, and publication date, making it easy for the frontend to display the data. I also added error handling and a fallback response to ensure the page remains functional if the external source is unavailable.

Brady Hormuth - I was responsible for the database design and implementation for our project. I used PostgreSQL to create the database and added prepopulated data. I was responsible for all levels of implementation, for the google O-Auth api to sign in with google. Additionally, I was heavily involved with troubleshooting the backend API, and ensuring system level requirements were met.

Nicole Reiner - Worked on the session and news page front end UIs. Created the modal for logging a new session. Ensured validation was applied correctly to inputs. Created the news cards and ensured all information shown was correct. Acted as project manager, taking meeting notes, assigning deliverables, and ensuring all lab rubric requirements were met.

Diyora Daminova - created the base template for Chip Companion and designed the final presentation slides. She developed key features including the sessions page, main landing page, and session calculations. She also set up the GitHub repository and established the overall project structure.

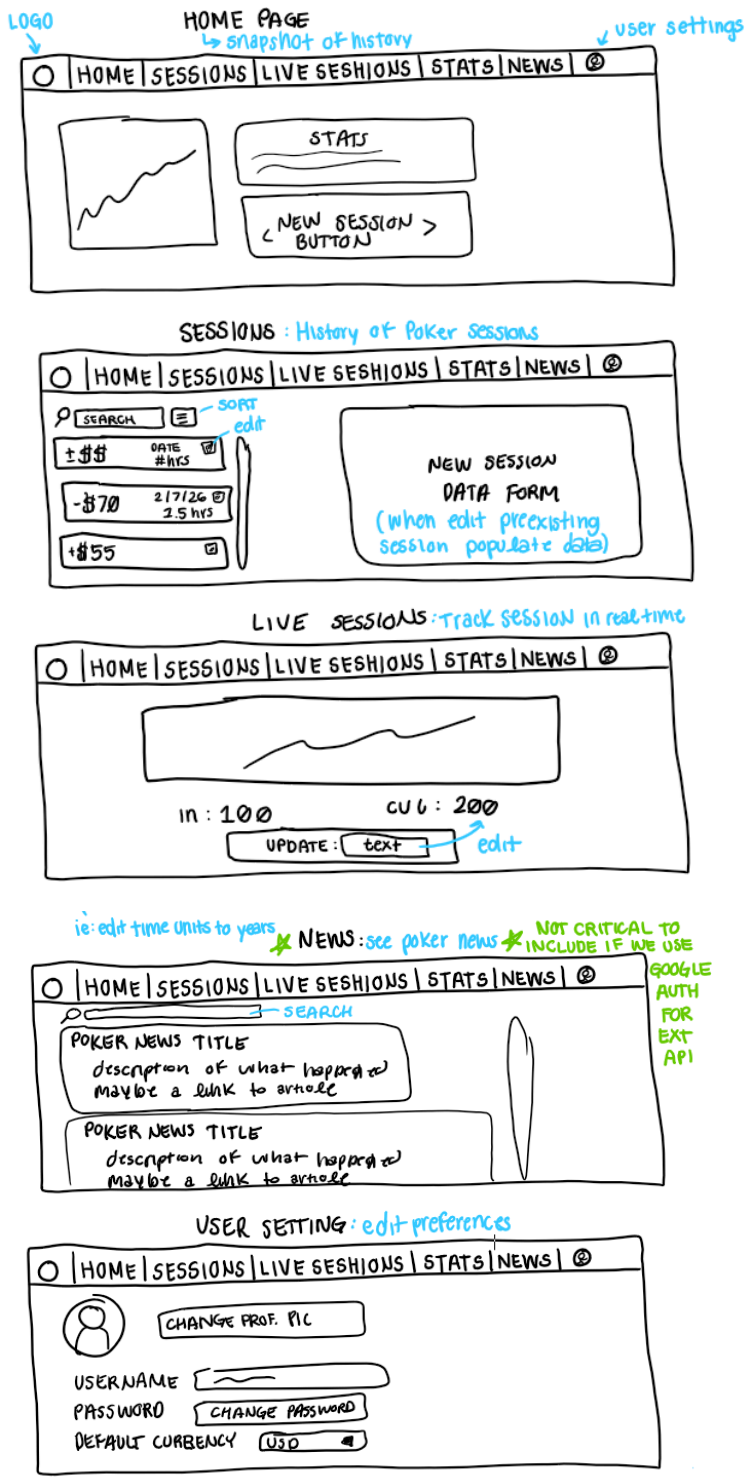
Use Case Diagram



Users can access the sessions page which allows them to log sessions, edit existing sessions, and start a live session. This enables them to view their poker session statistics. Users can also view the news tab, which calls the cardplayer.com poker news API to display current poker news. Users can also login using the google authenticator service or their email and password. They also have the ability to edit their account settings and information.

Wireframes

Wireframe diagrams are found below.



Test Results

There were 3 major user acceptance tests. A summary of them and their observations and results based on real user testing are below.

1. **Successfully submitting a session form - Nicole**
    - **Description**: Verify users can successfully populate and submit a poker session data form, and that newly submitted session is correctly displayed in the session list.
    - **Test data (and User Activity)**: Navigate to the sessions page. Click the "Log New Session" button. Enter valid data in all required fields. Click Submit. Here is an example of valid data:

Input Field (* are required)	Value
Date*	04/01/2026
Hours Played*	5
Buy-In*	500
Cash Out*	750
Number of Rebuys	1
Rebuy Amount	50
Location	Bellagio
Small Blind*	10
Big Blind*	20

    - **Test environment**: localhost
    - **Expected results**: Form modal closes. The session appears in the session list and displays the correct values. No error messages show and return 200 successful code status. Upon page refresh or newly navigating to the session page again, the submission will still be present in the session list.
    - **Tester information reflective of target users**: The tester should be familiar with poker session tracking concepts (such as buy-in, cash out, etc). The tester should have basic web app navigation skills.
    - **Test Results**: The user navigated to the session page after logging in. The user noted that the sessions page loaded quickly. The user clicked the add session button and the session modal popped up. The user input the data outlined in the test plan. The user pressed save and the modal disappeared. The session was

added to the session list. The console showed no errors. The user refreshed the page and the session was still there

- **User Observations**: The users noted that it was easy to navigate to the session page and that it loaded quickly. The user observed that it was easy to use, with the only comment to re-order optional fields at the bottom of the form to save time. The user noted that it was intuitive to use.

2. **Navbar always works - Brady**
    - **No matter what page redirects you to home**
    - **Description:** Verify that the navigation bar works properly, and users can navigate to each page individually. This functionality should work for each page on our website, and the user should be able to navigate to the home page from anywhere.
    - **Test data:** For each page on the web application, ensure that each hotlink on the navigation bar redirects you to the correct page.
    - **Test environment**: localhost
    - **Expected results:** Clicking on the "home" hotlink should navigate to the home page. Clicking on the "live sessions" hotlink should navigate the user to the live sessions page. This pattern should work for every hotlink on every page.
    - **Tester information reflective of target users:** The tester should have working knowledge on how navigation bars should typically work as well as a basic familiarity with the layout and structure of Chip Companion.
    - **Test Results:** The user navigated to each page and clicked the header. The user was redirected to the home page when clicking on the icon for each page.
    - **Test Observations**: The user noted that having the button redirect to home was a useful feature in the cases where they got lost in the application and wanted to return to a known location.

3. **Editing a session form - Trace**
    - **Description:** Verify the success of changing the contents of previously added / saved sessions. Newly inputted data should be reflected in the session list, with the pre edit session no longer existing.
    - **Test data:** Once navigated to the session page, click "edit session" next to any of the listed sessions. Once in the edit modal, the user may either "Save" or "Exit" (without saving any changes). This will pop up a confirmation message, that allows the user to cancel and return to editing the session, or confirm their action. The user has access to all of the same input fields as when making a new session, but are not required to edit any of them, however, * marked fields are not allowed to be made blank. Same example data as the submitted session.

Input Field (* are required)	Value
Date*	04/01/2026
Hours Played*	5
Buy-In*	500
Cash Out*	750
Number of Rebuys	1
Rebuy Amount	50
Location	Bellagio
Small Blind*	10
Big Blind*	20

- **Test environment:** localhost
- **Expected results:** Form modal closes. A success message appears. Session appears in the session list with updated values. No error messages show and return 200 successful code status. Upon page refresh, or returning in a later session, the edited session with its new values will still appear on the session list. Alternatively, if the user exited without saving changes, the session list will look the same as it did before they took action.
- **Tester information reflective of target users:** The tester should be aware of poker concepts that the session tracks (buy-in / cash out, location, etc.) User should have basic web navigation skills, with the ability to type information into forms.
- **Test Results:** The user clicked the edit button and opened up the edit modal which was prepopulated with the correct session data. The user made the edits outlined above. The user clicked save, the modal closed, and the changes were reflected. The user clicked edit again and closed the modal, and the session data was how it was before he clicked edit.
- **User Observations**: The user noted that editing the session made it easy to correct mistakes while entering sessions. The user noted that having the same UI as creating a session made it easier as the user was familiar with the layout. The user noted that he wished there was an animation on a successful update to provide visual feedback that the update was a success.

Deployment

The API and database was hosted on Render free tier. The database was initialized using a .sh script that connected to the DB using the postgres package and the external URI key. The link to access the application is below.

https://chip-companion.onrender.com/

Note, due to the free tier of render, the website spins down when inactive and may take a minute or so to spin back up.

README

The README can be found in the root directory of the project.